

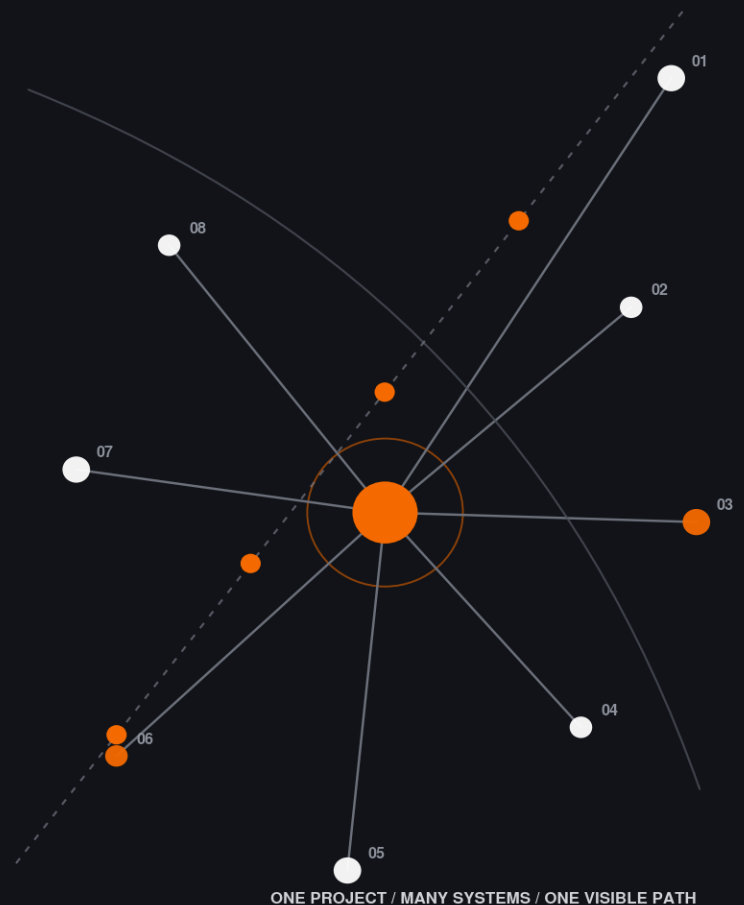
THE AIRPORT INFRASTRUCTURE DELIVERY GAP

Why critical airport projects lose momentum between funding, procurement, approvals, delivery and closeout - and the intelligence layer designed to keep them moving.

AN INDUSTRY POINT OF VIEW

Airport procurement intelligence

Innovation at the heart of airports.



01 / EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Airport projects do not have a work shortage. They have a continuity problem.

The need is visible. The complete path from need to funded, compliant and explainable delivery is not.

THE CENTRAL FINDING

Airport professionals are being asked to deliver highly regulated, publicly funded infrastructure through systems that were never designed to reason together.

A single airport project can touch FAA eligibility, grant assurances, federal procurement standards, local authority, airport policy, governance calendars, funding match, contract provisions, delivery changes and closeout documentation. Each obligation is legitimate. The risk appears where context must move between them.

-
- **01 The problem is fragmented reasoning.** People and systems hold pieces of the path, but no shared layer connects them.
 - **02 The cost is decision reconstruction.** Teams repeat research, reassemble rationale and rediscover downstream consequences.
 - **03 The opportunity is airport procurement intelligence.** Connect project facts to the right path, evidence and next action.

02 / WHO THIS IS FOR

For the people responsible for moving airport infrastructure forward.

Different roles see different parts of the same project. The delivery gap appears in the handoffs between them.

01 AIRPORT DIRECTORS

Set priorities, protect public accountability and keep the full capital program moving.

02 ADMIN + FINANCE

Align budgets, authority, funding match, approvals and the operating realities behind the project.

03 CAPITAL + PROJECT LEADERS

Translate need into scope, sequence, procurement, delivery and a defensible record.

04 PROCUREMENT + GRANTS

Connect competition, eligibility, clauses, documentation, reimbursement and closeout.

05 CONSULTANTS

Bring specialized expertise into an airport-owned path that remains useful after the engagement.

THE SHARED REQUIREMENT

Each role needs the same project facts, the same visible reasoning and a record that survives the next handoff.

03 / THE CAPITAL REALITY

Two credible numbers. Two different lenses. One enormous delivery challenge.

The industry’s infrastructure need is not a single number because the studies answer different questions.

\$173.9B ACI–NA airport-reported needs 2025–2029 / broad industry lens A wider universe of airport-identified needs, including inflation, emerging priorities and deferred projects.	\$67.5B FAA NPIAS development 2025–2029 / federal planning lens Development FAA identifies as eligible and justified within the National Plan of Integrated Airport Systems.
---	---

These figures should not be subtracted or treated as competing estimates. Their scopes differ. Read together, they reveal the size of the capital agenda—and the importance of turning plans into fundable, procurable and deliverable projects.

WHAT THE NUMBERS CANNOT SHOW

A capital program is only as strong as the chain of decisions that turns need into completed infrastructure.

Verified: ACI–NA (March 26, 2025), \$173.9B; FAA NPIAS (September 30, 2024; updated July 22, 2026), \$67.5B. Direct URLs on page 17. Accessed August 28, 2026.

04 / THE OPERATING ENVIRONMENT

Airport procurement is not ordinary procurement.

It is infrastructure delivery inside an active transportation system, under layered public obligations.

A choice can be commercially reasonable and still create a funding, approval, documentation or closeout problem downstream. The same project must satisfy several kinds of logic at once.

01 OPERATIONAL

Protect safety, access and continuity while the airport remains in service.

02 FUNDING

Align scope, eligibility, justification, timing and match.

03 PROCUREMENT

Select the right method, competition path and supporting record.

04 GOVERNANCE

Map authority, public process and decision calendars.

05 CONTRACT

Carry applicable clauses, certifications and preferences into the work.

06 LIFECYCLE

Administer changes, reimbursement, closeout and future maintenance.

A BETTER DIAGNOSIS

Complexity is not evidence of dysfunction. It is the natural result of multiple legitimate obligations converging on one project.

05 / THE RULE ENVIRONMENT

One project. Many rulebooks.

The correct decision is rarely contained in a single manual, policy or system.

ONE PROJECT / SIX OPERATING DOMAINS



For AIP-funded work, FAA guidance sits alongside 2 CFR Part 200, grant assurances and project-specific terms. Professional services may require qualifications-based selection. Contract provisions vary by type and size. DBE or ACDBE obligations, domestic-preference requirements and local authority can add further branches.

THE DECIDING FACTOR

The path depends on the project's facts: what is being purchased, how it is funded, the anticipated value, the airport's authority, the market, the schedule and the record already created.

Sources: FAA AIP Handbook and procurement guidance; 2 CFR Part 200; FAA DBE/ACDBE and Buy American guidance. Requirements vary by project.

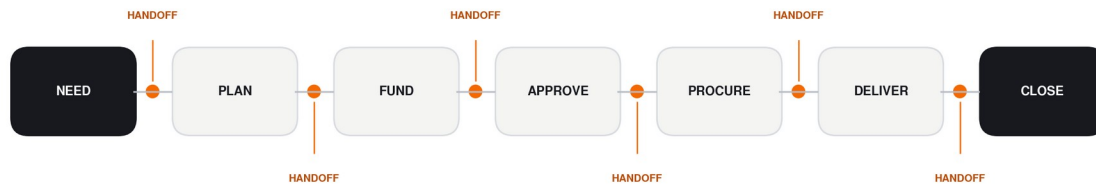
06 / WHERE MOMENTUM IS LOST

Projects rarely stall in one dramatic moment.

Momentum leaks when context crosses from one owner, system or phase to another.

MOMENTUM LEAKS BETWEEN THE BOXES

Different owners. Different systems. Different clocks. One public record.



The handoff is the risk surface.

NEED → PLAN The problem is clear; the enabling plan, justification or dependency is not.

PLAN → FUND The scope is real; eligibility, match, timing or reimbursement assumptions remain unresolved.

FUND → APPROVE The funding path is understood; authority and public-process lead times are not.

APPROVE → PROCURE The method begins before scope, clauses, evaluation or approval logic is ready.

PROCURE → DELIVER Solicitation commitments do not travel into administration and change control.

DELIVER → CLOSE Evidence is scattered, memory has moved on and the record must be rebuilt.

THE PATTERN

Infrastructure does not stall in one place. It loses momentum between systems.

07 / THE HIDDEN OPERATING COST

The file may contain the documents without containing the decision.

Storage is not continuity. A folder can preserve artifacts while losing the path that produced them.

“The next person inherits the documents—not the why.”

Federal procurement standards require records sufficient to detail procurement history—including rationale for method and contract type, contractor selection or rejection, and basis for price. Saving emails and final documents does not automatically preserve that history.

RESEARCH

Rules and precedents are searched again.

REVIEW

Approvers receive artifacts without assumptions and dependencies.

CHANGE

A new fact forces the team to rediscover downstream consequences.

TURNOVER

Knowledge leaves with staff, consultants or leadership.

AUDIT / CLOSEOUT

The record is reconstructed retrospectively, under pressure.

Source: 2 CFR § 200.318(i), General procurement standards—documentation of procurement history.

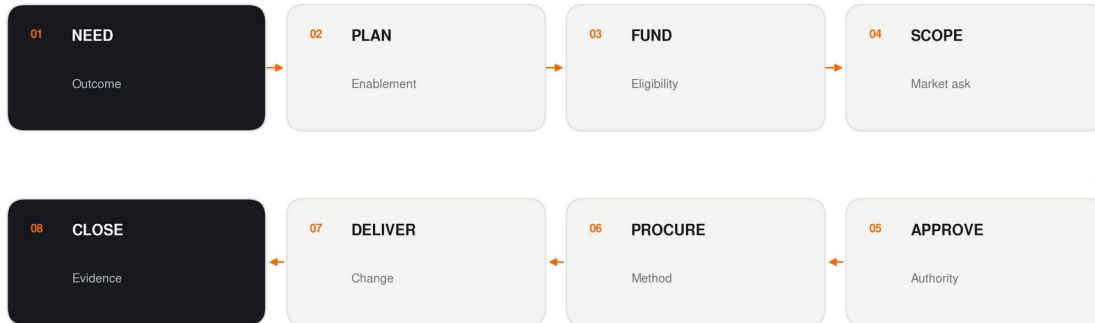
08 / THE LIFECYCLE VIEW

Procurement is not the bid. It is a chain of decisions.

The solicitation is a visible event inside a much longer infrastructure lifecycle.

PROCUREMENT IS THE MIDDLE OF THE STORY—not the beginning.

Every upstream decision creates downstream requirements.



Each stage creates evidence that must travel forward: the need statement, planning dependencies, funding assumptions, scope and estimate, approval authority, competition and selection record, contract administration, reimbursement and closeout.

THE CONTINUITY REQUIREMENT

Every upstream decision creates downstream requirements. Every downstream change can invalidate an upstream assumption.

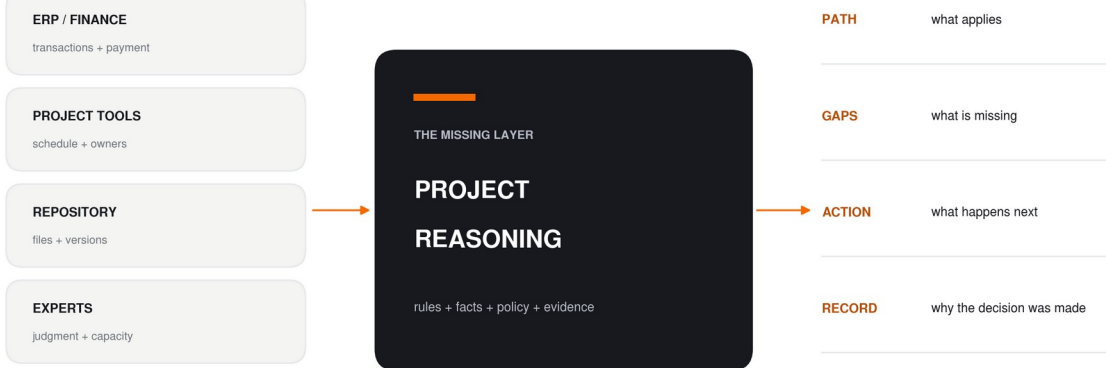
Treating procurement as a lifecycle makes the real need visible: continuity of reasoning, not merely continuity of files.

09 / THE SYSTEMS LANDSCAPE

The tools airports already have are necessary—and incomplete.

Most systems are effective at their assigned job. The gap is the logic between them.

SYSTEMS OF RECORD STORE THE WORK. AN INTELLIGENCE LAYER EXPLAINS THE WORK.



ERP systems record transactions. Project tools organize schedules and owners. Repositories preserve files. Consultants and counsel provide specialized judgment. None is designed to connect the project question to governing sources, airport policy, missing facts, decision logic, evidence and next action.

THE CATEGORY GAP

The missing layer is not another place to store information. It is a system that explains what the information means for this project, at this airport, now.

TarmacSync is designed to sit across existing systems—not replace them.

10 / A NEW OPERATING LAYER

The missing layer is airport procurement intelligence.

An operating layer that turns rules, airport policy and project facts into a traceable path forward across the infrastructure lifecycle.

It does not make the decision for the airport. It makes the decision environment legible.

Airport procurement intelligence reveals the path, separates facts from assumptions, surfaces what is missing, links conclusions to sources and keeps the evidence beside the action it supports.

01**KNOW THE PATH**

See the funding, procurement, approval and delivery route for the project in front of you.

02**EXPLAIN THE DECISION**

Keep the source, project fact and rationale connected to the outcome.

03**PRESERVE THE EXPERTISE**

Turn individual experience into reusable airport intelligence without flattening local judgment.

THE CATEGORY PROMISE**Know the path. Keep the airport project moving.**

11 / THE TARMACSYNC APPROACH

From project question to traceable next action.

TarmacSync organizes the reasoning work that currently falls between systems.

FROM QUESTION TO TRACEABLE NEXT ACTION

Human judgment remains in control. The reasoning becomes visible and reusable.



One workspace. One path. Evidence beside the conclusion.

A project begins with what the airport knows. TarmacSync routes those facts through a project-specific path, exposes missing information and keeps sources beside the reasoning. The result is an action-ready record the team can review, approve, reuse and carry forward.

THE PRACTICAL DIFFERENCE

One project workspace. A visible path. Sources beside the conclusion. Evidence that survives the handoff.

TarmacSync supports professional judgment and coordination. It does not replace FAA determinations, legal advice, an airport's governing authority or specialized consultant expertise.

12 / WHAT CHANGES

The airport keeps its people and systems. The work gains continuity.

TarmacSync changes how project reasoning travels—not who owns the decision.

WITHOUT A SHARED LAYER	WITH TARMACSYNC
Search manuals, sites, folders and prior files.	Start from a curated, source-linked path.
Hold exceptions and approval nuance in staff memory.	Make airport-specific authority and policy visible.
Discover missing facts during review or solicitation.	Surface missing information before the next step.
Reuse generic templates, then reconstruct context.	Carry project facts into action-ready work.
Reassemble emails, notes and attachments.	Keep source, fact, rationale and approval together.
Transfer files and hope the context follows.	Transfer a decision record and a live next-action path.

THE OUTCOME

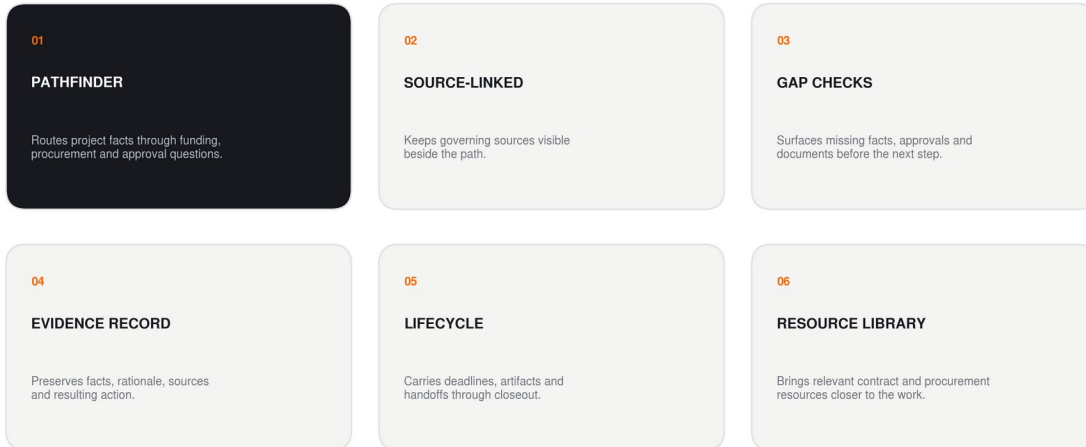
Not ‘faster procurement’ at any cost. Less avoidable friction, earlier visibility and a stronger decision record.

13 / CURRENT PRODUCT

What TarmacSync is built to do today.

Project-level airport procurement intelligence—grounded in sources, shaped by local context and preserved through the lifecycle.

CURRENT PRODUCT / PROJECT-LEVEL AIRPORT PROCUREMENT INTELLIGENCE



CLEAR BOUNDARY

TarmacSync is an airport procurement intelligence platform—not an ERP, e-procurement marketplace, document vault or substitute for professional authority.

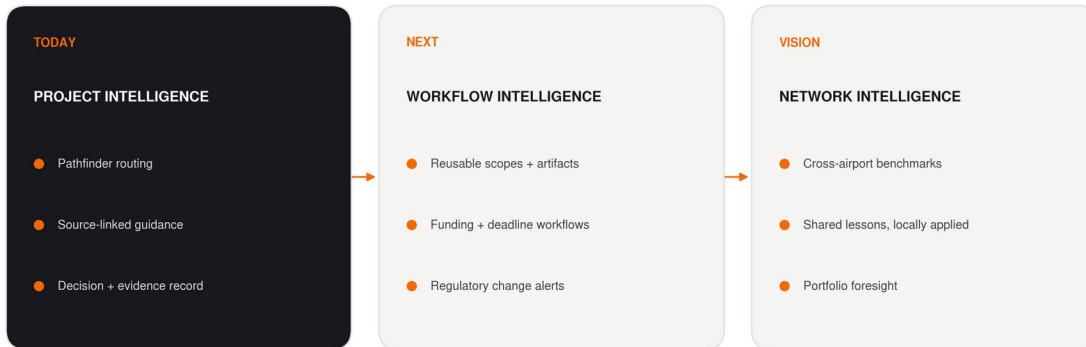
Its job is to help airport teams know the path, explain the decision and preserve the expertise required to keep critical infrastructure moving.

14 / FUTURE VISION

From project intelligence to a connected airport infrastructure network.

The long-term opportunity is to help every airport learn faster—without losing local control.

FROM ONE PROJECT TO A CONNECTED AIRPORT NETWORK



As the platform grows, TarmacSync can turn repeated industry work into structured intelligence: reusable scopes and procurement artifacts adapted to local standards; end-to-end funding and application workflows; regulatory change monitoring; and benchmarks that show how peer airports sequence, fund and deliver comparable infrastructure.

THE NETWORK EFFECT

Imagine the next airport project beginning with the lessons of thousands before it—organized, source-linked and locally applicable.

Items labeled NEXT and VISION describe planned direction and are not presented as currently available product capabilities.

15 / TRUST BY DESIGN

Useful intelligence must remain visible, bounded and accountable.

Trust is not a marketing claim. It is a product behavior.

01 SOURCE-VISIBLE

The team can see the authority behind the path instead of receiving an unexplained answer.

02 LOCALLY AWARE

Airport policy and governing authority can be applied above generic practice.

03 FACT-DISCIPLINED

Known facts, assumptions and missing information remain separate.

04 REPEATABLE

The same material facts route the same baseline path, making review easier.

05 HUMAN-CONTROLLED

Airport professionals retain approval, judgment and accountability.

Better infrastructure begins with better decision continuity.

The sector has the projects, professionals and public purpose. What it lacks is a shared intelligence layer built for the way airport infrastructure actually moves.

THE NEXT USEFUL STEP

A concise, airport-specific view of project readiness—built first from public information, with airport context added only when your team chooses.

GET THE AIRPORT PROJECT READINESS SNAPSHOT

No project handoff required. Start with public information; add airport context only when you choose.

16 / SOURCES AND METHOD

Evidence behind the report.

Public sources were selected for relevance to U.S. airport capital development and federally assisted procurement.

This report is an industry framing document, not legal, grant or procurement advice. Requirements vary by airport, project, funding source, contract type, value, jurisdiction and current agency direction. Readers should verify the rules and grant conditions applicable to their project.

Airports Council International–North America. [Modern Airports for a Stronger America: 2025–2029 Airport Infrastructure Needs Study — \\$173.9B statement; page modified March 26, 2025; accessed August 28, 2026](#)

Federal Aviation Administration. [National Plan of Integrated Airport Systems \(NPIAS\), 2025–2029 — \\$67.5B statement; published September 30, 2024; narrative updated July 22, 2026; accessed August 28, 2026](#)

Federal Aviation Administration. [Airport Improvement Program \(AIP\)](#)

Federal Aviation Administration. [AIP Handbook](#)

Federal Aviation Administration. [AIP Procurement](#)

Federal Aviation Administration. [Required Contract Provisions](#)

Federal Aviation Administration. [Procurement of Professional Services](#)

Electronic Code of Federal Regulations. [2 CFR Part 200; procurement standards beginning at § 200.317](#)

Federal Aviation Administration. [AIP Grant Assurances](#)

Federal Aviation Administration. [Buy American Preference](#)

Federal Aviation Administration. [DBE / Airport Concession DBE Programs](#)

Prepared by TarmacSync / Airport Procurement Intelligence / Draft for editorial and design review